Our final "working at the edges" function is `mb_strimwidth()`. This function removes characters from the end of the string to achieve a target length and will also remove characters from the beginning if desired. The following should make this clear:

```
$str = 'The quick brown fox';

print mb_strimwidth($str, 0, 6) . PHP_EOL;
print mb_strimwidth($str, 1, 6) . PHP_EOL;
print mb_strimwidth($str, 2, 6) . PHP_EOL;
print mb_strimwidth($str, 3, 6);
```

```
Output:
The qu
he qui
e quic
quick
```

It is also possible to append characters to the truncated string; the target length (argument three) will include these characters in its count:

```
print mb_strimwidth($str, 0, 6, '...') . PHP_EOL;
print mb_strimwidth($str, 0, 9, '...');
```

```
Output:
The...
The qu...
```

Like `mb_str_pad()`, there's a small but important qualifier for the concept of *width* when it comes to the output. `mb_str_pad()` counts codepoints, but `mb_strimwidth()` counts a rather confusing pair of properties called *halfwidth* and *fullwidth*. These are two terms that actually refer to typographic properties of characters, specifically those in East Asian text, although there are fullwidth forms of Latin text too. To make matters worse, there are half and full versions of many East Asian ideograms:

```
$halfSu = "\u{FF7D}"; // ｽ
$fullSu = "\u{30B9}"; // ス

print mb_strimwidth("Text", 0, 3, $halfSu) . PHP_EOL;
print mb_strimwidth("Text", 0, 3, $fullSu);
```